

DEPARTMENT OF INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

presents

13TH EDITION

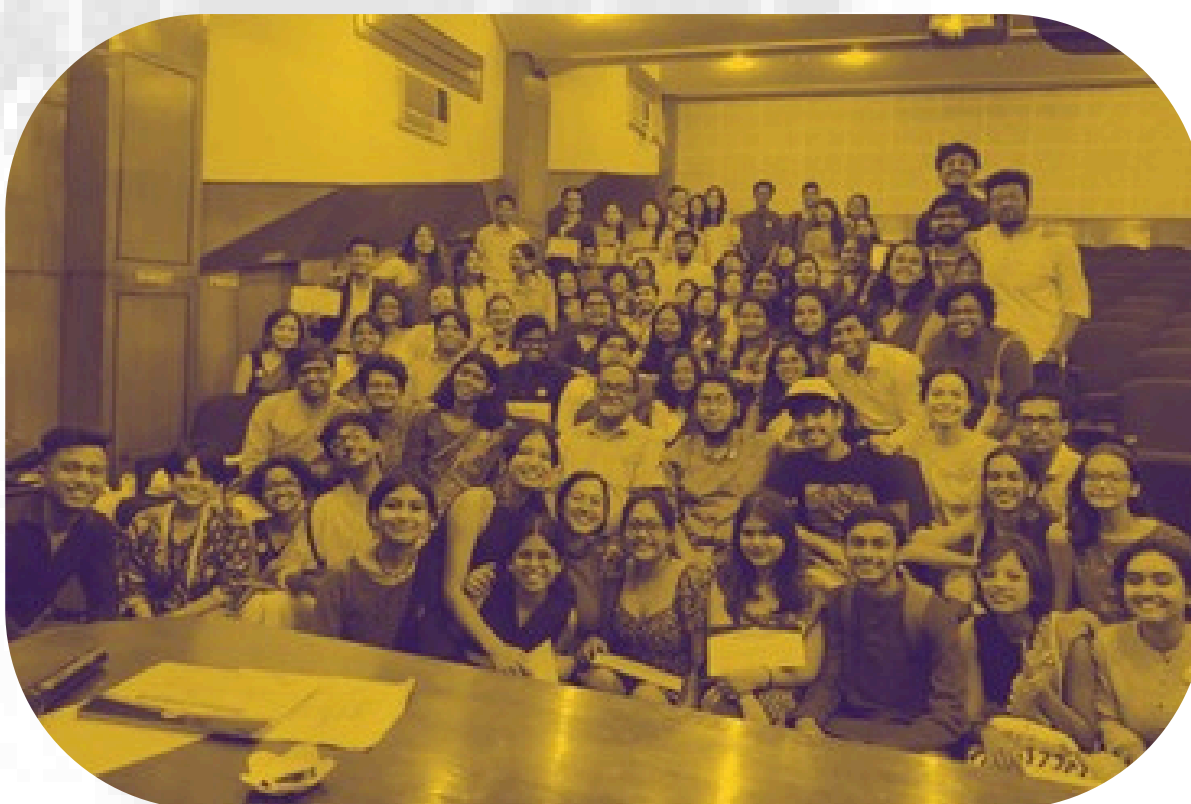
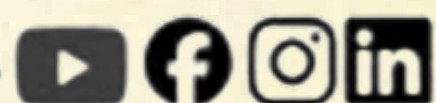


International
Relations
Scholastic
Conclave
2026

Event Brochure

PG Arts Building, 196,

Raja Subodh Chandra Mallick Rd,
Jadavpur University Campus Area,
Jadavpur , Kolkata,
West Bengal 700032

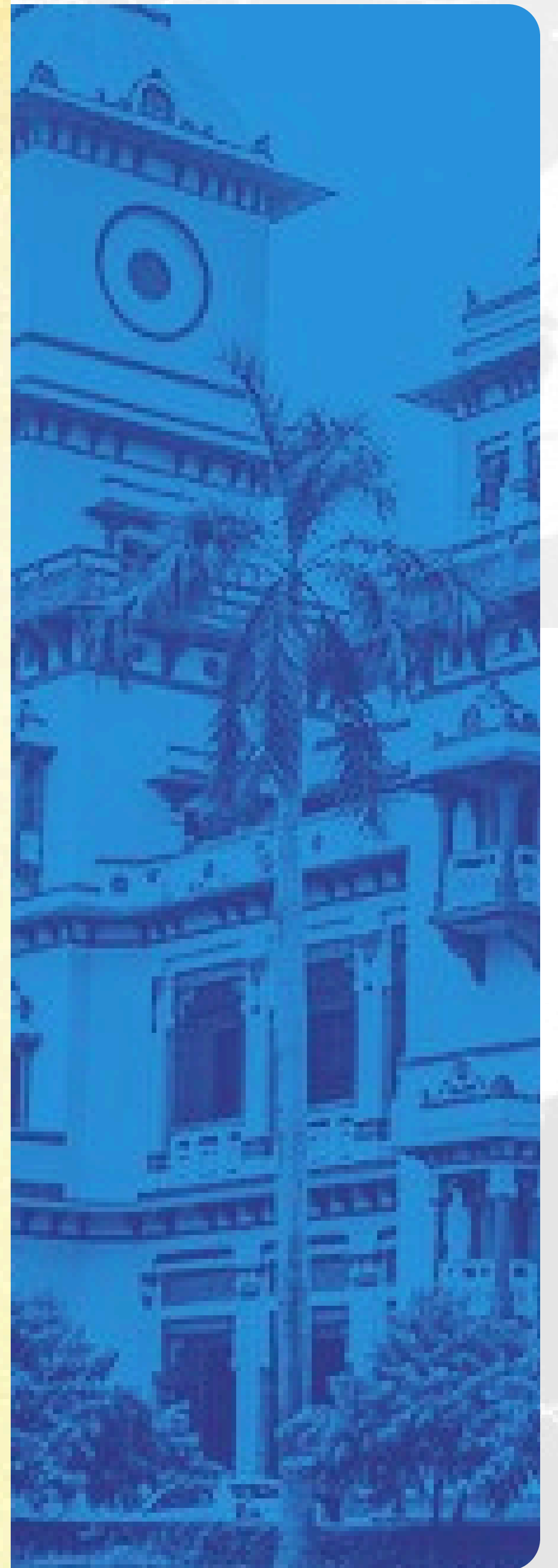


About the Department of International Relations

The Department of International Relations, established in 1956, is one of the oldest and most esteemed institutions in the country for the study of Political Science and International Relations. Over the years, the department has actively contributed to the evolution of political thought while maintaining a strong commitment to diverse and holistic academic learning. Recognized for its distinguished faculty and comprehensive curriculum, the department continuously strives for excellence in education and research. Our dedication and perseverance have earned us the reputation of being one of the most respected departments for International Relations in the country. We focus on equipping students with in-depth knowledge of global politics, national and international affairs, and contemporary geopolitical issues, particularly in political, strategic, and economic domains.

The department houses the Centre for Refugee Studies, a unique research hub in Eastern India, and boasts a well-stocked library with approximately 4,000 books covering relevant topics. Additionally, we subscribe to nearly 56 prestigious national and international journals. A standout feature of the department is the Tarak Nath Das Research Centre, which maintains an exclusive newspaper clipping archive—the only one of its kind in Eastern India—containing around 25,000 files on significant national and international issues.

The School of International Relations and Strategic Studies, set up by the department in 1987, encourages interdisciplinary approaches to advanced study and research in the field of international relations and strategic studies, promotes collaboration among scholars in analysing problems having multi-disciplinary dimensions, facilitates lectures, seminars, and workshops, funding research on issues of international concern.



About the International Relations Scholastic Conclave (IRSC)



The International Relations Scholastic Conclave, organised by the Department of International Relations at Jadavpur University, is a student-driven academic forum that brings together students, scholars, and professionals to engage with critical global issues. Since its inception in 2010, the conclave has been a pursuit of intellectual exploration, aiming to unravel the complexities of global politics. By convening a diverse group of experts and students, the event facilitates in-depth discussions and debates on key themes in International Relations. It serves as a platform to encourage critical thinking, promote academic excellence, and bridge the gap between theory and real-world practice. Building on the success of the previous edition, which featured distinguished speakers such as Christophe Jaffrelot, Liyaqat Ayub Khan, Alka Acharya, and Esther Brito Ruiz, whose expertise spans areas like Indology, South Asian politics, Sino-Indian relations, human rights, and diplomacy, this year's conclave will further expand its outreach. The upcoming edition aims to enhance student participation alongside international experts, ensuring broader engagement and a more dynamic exchange of ideas. With an anticipated increase in attendance, the impact and reach of the event are expected to be greater than ever. Scheduled for September, 2026, the conference is strategically planned to maximize participation from the Organizing Committee, attendees, and esteemed guests from prestigious national and international universities and institutions.

IRSC 2026 VISION

Can strategic autonomy survive in an age of shifting alliances and geopolitical uncertainty?

Can India emerge as a leading power while retaining its strategic autonomy in a multipolar world?

Questions like these have increasingly shaped contemporary international politics. The post–Cold War global order is steadily fragmenting, while a new multipolar order continues to emerge through geopolitical realignments, technological transformations, economic competition, climate crises, and hybrid threats. While the world has undoubtedly moved beyond a unipolar structure, there remains uncertainty regarding what kind of global order will ultimately replace it.

This brings us to the reality that we are living in a period of transition, one marked by uncertainty, strategic competition, and evolving centres of power. States today are constantly negotiating between cooperation and conflict, national interests and global responsibilities, technological advancement and security vulnerabilities. The contemporary international landscape therefore demands a rethinking of traditional ideas surrounding power, governance, diplomacy, and global stability.

Inspired by these changing realities, IRSC 2026 seeks to critically engage with the theme of **“Strategic Autonomy and Global Re-alignment: Exploring India’s Prospects in a Multipolar World”**.

This theme has been chosen for its broad and interdisciplinary character. It seeks to create discussions surrounding global governance, the geopolitics of the Indo-Pacific and Eurasia, non-Western perspectives in International Relations, emerging technologies, climate governance, migration, hybrid threats, connectivity corridors, and the vision of **Viksit Bharat2047**.



Team IRSC
Department Of International Relations
Jadavpur University



Theme

Strategic Autonomy and Global
Re-alignment: Exploring India's
Prospects In a Multipolar World.

9th - 11th
SEPTEMBER

Dates
for
IRSC



Conference Details

S U B - T H E M E S

The Theory and
Praxis of Strategic
Autonomy in a
Multipolar
Landscape

India, Global
Governance, and
the New World
Order: From Bridge-
Building to Agenda-
Setting

Geopolitics of
Connectivity and
Contestation in the
Indo-Pacific and
Eurasia

Focus: Bridging the gap between IR theories (Realism, Liberalism, Constructivism, etc.) and the practical foreign policy choices of emerging powers, especially India.

Discussion Points:

- Conceptual evolution of 'Strategic Autonomy' from Non-Alignment to 'Multi-Alignment'.
- The economics of autonomy: decoupling, resilient supply chains, and technology sovereignty.
- Autonomy vs. Interdependence: Identifying the thresholds where cooperation becomes compromise.
- Case studies on how middle powers operationalize their strategic autonomy, including defense procurement and multilateral negotiations.

Focus: Analyzing India's growing role in shaping global norms and institutions.

Discussion Points:

- India's 'Vishwaguru' or 'Vishwabandhu' approach and its resonance with the Global South.
- Reforming multilateral institutions (UN, WTO, IMF) in the age of multipolarity
- The role of plurilateral groupings (QUAD, BRICS+, I2U2) as alternatives to traditional alliances.
- Evaluating India's leadership in the G20 and its advocacy for issues like climate justice and debt relief.

Focus: Examining the critical geographic theaters where great power competition and regional interdependence are most pronounced.

Discussion Points:

- Maritime security and freedom of navigation: The rules-based order versus spheres of influence.
- Competing connectivity initiatives (IMEC, BRICS, Act East Policy): Infrastructure as a tool of strategic influence.
- Managing border disputes and security dilemmas in the multipolar context (e.g., India-China relations).
- The energy-security nexus and the pursuit of resilient energy corridors in a world of sanctions and dependencies.



Conference Details

S U B - T H E M E S

Non-Western
Perspectives and
Civilizational States
in Contemporary IR
Theory

Emerging and
Disruptive
Technologies: New
Frontiers of Power
and Vulnerability

Strategic Autonomy
in Hybrid Threats

Vision Vikshit Bharat
@ 2047

Focus: Decolonizing IR scholarship and integrating non-Eurocentric concepts into the study of international affairs.

Discussion Points:

- The foreign policy grammar of 'civilizational states' (e.g., India, China) and its divergence from the Westphalian model.
- Integrating ancient wisdom and philosophical concepts (like Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam) into modern diplomatic practice.
- The challenge of universalizing norms from a multipolar/multicultural base.
- How non-Western IR scholars are redefining concepts like power, sovereignty, and state-society relations.

Focus: Exploring the impact of technology on state power, interdependence, and the nature of conflict.

Discussion Points:

- Cybersecurity, data governance, and the digital divide as geopolitical battlegrounds.
- The competition for critical and emerging technologies such as semiconductors, AI, and quantum computing.
- Dual-use technology and its implications for non-proliferation and strategic stability.
- Ethical and regulatory frameworks for technology in a globalized but fragmented world.

Focusing on India's responses to disinformation, terrorism, and grey-zone warfare, including its space and nuclear doctrines

Examining India's Prospects and Challenges to meet the 2047 targets, and understanding India's standing in realising the SDG 2030 commitments.



PAPER PRESENTATION

Changing Polarity in International System and
the Future of Strategic Autonomy

Ongoing shifts in global power structures are redefining the conditions under which states operate. Attention is given to how these transitions influence India's ability to remain strategically independent.

It explores both the constraints and opportunities emerging from a changing world order. The broader aim is to assess how autonomy can be preserved and strengthened amid continuous global transformation.

For Queries:
Diptajyoti: 7866823834
Mohana: 7384846733

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
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Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



The Paper Presentation is a formal platform for participants to present their original research and analytical insights. It aims to encourage critical thinking, structured argumentation, and academic discussion about the global order. Each presentation will be followed by a brief interactive discussion with the panel to facilitate intellectual engagement and scholarly exchange, thereby expanding the horizon of international relations research.

TOPIC:

Changing Polarity in International System and the Future of Strategic Autonomy

Ongoing shifts in global power structures are redefining the conditions under which states operate. Attention is given to how these transitions influence India's ability to remain strategically independent. It explores both the constraints and opportunities emerging from a changing world order. The broader aim is to assess how autonomy can be preserved and strengthened amid continuous global transformation.

Participants may submit papers or presentations on the following sub-themes (these are indicative, not exhaustive)

1. Evolving Global Governance: From Cooperation to Strategic Direction

- a) Crisis-Driven Governance and Adaptive Responses
- b) Reforming Global Institutions in Response to Changing Power Structures
- c) The Rise of the Global South in Agenda-Setting
- d) India's Shift from Multilateral Engagement to Selective Minilateral Leadership
- e) Sea Power and Vulnerability: Securing Strategic Maritime Routes

2. Strategic Autonomy in Hybrid Threats

- a) Digital Sovereignty and Strategic Autonomy: Cyber Threats and Information Warfare
- b) The Politics of Energy: Security, Supply Chains, and Strategic Leverage
- c) Oceans as Arenas of Power: Maritime Security and Strategic Bottlenecks
- d) Energy Geopolitics: Security, Dependence, and Global Rivalries
- e) Internal Fragility and External Pressure: Security in a Polarised Age

3. Geopolitics of Connectivity: Cooperation, Contestation, and Control

- a) Strategic Corridors and Competing Connectivity Projects
- b) Geoeconomics of Connectivity: Trade Routes, Supply Chains, and Dependence
- c) Globalisation and the Return of Borders: Northeast India as a Commodity and Connectivity Frontier
- d) Regionalism and Connectivity: Cooperation beyond Great Powers
- e) Security Dilemmas in Connectivity Projects

4. Technology as Power: Emerging Domains of Conflict and Vulnerability

- a) Artificial Intelligence in Warfare and Strategic Decision-Making
- b) Information Warfare, Disinformation, and Cognitive Security
- c) Space Militarisation
- d) Biotechnology and Biosecurity
- e) Critical Minerals and Resource and Geopolitics

RULES AND REGULATIONS:

- The event will be bilingual: Papers shall be accepted in both Bengali and English
- The abstract must be within 300 words, font style Times New Roman 12, specify 4-5 key words, and contain a short bio note of the authors
- The title page must clearly state the name, designation, institution's name and contact details of the author/authors
- The paper should follow the following structure- title of the paper, abstract, keywords, introduction, methodology, literature review, findings, recommendations, conclusion and reference.
- Abstracts must be sent in PDF/.doc format with the name saved in the following manner: FullName_Institution_PaperAbstract.
- The submission shall be made through a Google Form.
- The last date for submission of abstracts shall be *21st August, 2026*
- Selected participants shall be notified on *27th August, 2026*
- The selected participants must submit the full paper by *3rd September, 2026*
- The final paper must be 5000 words or fewer. Font style - Times New Roman 12, spacing 1.5. Citation APA 7th gen.
- Plagiarism and the use of AI are strictly prohibited and shall result in immediate disqualification
- All qualifying participants need to send their PowerPoint presentation by the specified date
- Each participant shall be allotted 10 minutes for presentation and 5 minutes for questions.
- The presentation shall be conducted in **Hybrid Form**. Only participants from outside Kolkata shall be allowed to present online.

REGISTRATION:

- The event is open to undergraduate and postgraduate students (JUNIOR category) and research scholars & faculty members (SENIOR category) from all disciplines.
- A paper can have a maximum of 3 co-authors
- **Registration fee for selected abstracts shall be:**
Undergraduate - Rs. 200, Postgraduate - Rs. 300, Research Scholar/Faculty - Rs. 500

Submit your abstract at-

irscresearch2026@gmail.com

Rs.4000
Research Scholar

Rs.2000
Under-Graduate

Rs.3000
Post-Graduate



Qoutūhol

IRSC Open Quiz Championship

Qoutūhol (কৌতূহল) is the Bengali word for curiosity — not the mild, easily-satisfied kind, but the condition of the mind that cannot leave a question alone. Wonder with urgency. The feeling that makes a person, upon learning something, immediately need to know what connects to it. It is, in the deepest sense, the main reason a quiz exists.

Qoutūhol is the city-wide Open Quiz Championship hosted by the International Relations Scholastic Conclave, Jadavpur University — an open competition built on the proposition that genuine, wide-ranging curiosity is not a personality trait. It is a practice. And when tested against the right questions, in the right room, it is the most honest measure of an educated mind.

For Queries:
Kushal: 7638932359
Promit: 9051071498

For Registration:

<https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9>



The IR-themed Quiz is a two-member team event designed to test the participants' knowledge and reasoning on multipolarity, strategic autonomy, and contemporary global affairs. The competition will begin with a preliminary round, followed by a multi-round final with dynamic and challenging segments, each aimed at fostering analytical thinking, teamwork, and informed engagement with international relations.

RULES AND REGULATIONS:

- The event shall be conducted in three rounds:
Preliminary Round
Semi-Final Round
Final Round
- Hall Prelims shall be held on the day of the event. The qualifying 10 teams, along with two more teams selected through City-wide Prelims, shall qualify for the Semi-Finals
- City-wide Prelims Round to be conducted before the day of Qoutūhol.
- 6 teams shall qualify from the Semi-Finals for a multi-round Final
- Unfair practices, including cheating, external help, or the use of electronic devices like mobile phones, smart watches, shall result in immediate disqualification.
- The Quiz master's decisions regarding questions, scoring, and results shall be final.

REGISTRATION:

- Team registrations (of two participants) are allowed.
- There is no Registration Fee for this event.

Spot registration is allowed.

Cash Prize For Top 6

Exciting Goodies For
Audience Rounds



Committee Simulation

SHANGHAI COOPERATION ORGANISATION

Ongoing shifts in global power structures are redefining the conditions under which states operate. Attention is given to how these transitions influence India's ability to remain strategically independent.

It explores both the constraints and opportunities emerging from a changing world order. The broader aim is to assess how autonomy can be preserved and strengthened amid continuous global transformation.

For Queries:
Yashika: 6291699199
Adrija: 6291540756

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
Q7rw44K5e1P7TL
Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



SHANGHAI COOPERATION ORGANISATION

REGISTRATION

- The event is open for high school (+2), undergraduate, and postgraduate students from all disciplines.
- Both individual and team registrations (of two/three participants) are allowed.
- **Registration Fee: Single Delegation – Rs. 900. Double Delegation – Rs. 1700. Triple Delegation – Rs.2500**

GENERAL GUIDELINES

- The participants shall be able to select their portfolio from the allocation matrix attached to the registration link (subject to availability of portfolios and the experience of the delegates)
- English will be the Official medium for communication during the event
- The Participants shall be provided with the detailed agenda and a study guide
- The Rules of Procedure shall be explained by the Executive Board before the committee proceedings

Rs.8000
Best Delegate

Rs.4000
Special Mention

Rs.6000
High Commendation



Penquest

Essay Competition

IRSC's essay writing event creates a platform for sustained academic engagement with the core areas of international affairs. Through their original write-ups, participants are expected to apply theoretical frameworks, conduct research and analysis, and present their own inferences on the ever-evolving geopolitical landscape. This event encourages clarity of thought, depth of research, and the ability to craft original, persuasive, well-structured reflections on the forces shaping our global order

For Queries:

Jayasmita: 9641215740

Kangkana: 7908633186

For Registration:

**[https://forms.gle/
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Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)**



TOPIC:

Junior Category:

1. Situating women in India's framework to realise Vikshit Bharat@2047
2. Reassessing India's position as a voice of the Global South

Senior Category:

1. Rethinking Diaspora as a strategic actor across global economic frameworks.
2. Envisioning a new multilateral digital order in the age of AI

RULES AND REGULATIONS

REGISTRATION:

- The event is open for students from 9th to 12th grade: Junior Category,
- Undergraduate and above: Senior Category
- **Registration Fee: Junior Category- 100, Senior Category- 200**

Last date for submissions : 3rd September, 2026

- The event will be bilingual: essays shall be accepted in both Bengali and English
- Participants must write an essay on any of the given topics according to their specified category
- Each participant can only submit one essay. Multiple submissions shall lead to disqualification
- The essay must be between 800 and 1500 words.
- Participants must use Times New Roman font, Font size 12.
- Citation: APA 7th generation (not necessary for junior category)
- Plagiarism is strictly prohibited and shall result in disqualification
- The first page must clearly mention the Topic, Participant's full name and contact information, current academic status, and institution.
- All submissions shall be in PDF format. Save your PDF as: FullName_Institution_Essay
- Submissions must be uploaded via the submission form before the deadline
- Essays shall be assessed based on originality and clarity of content, quality of analysis and research, and language and structure of the essay.

1st

Rs.3000
Senior Category

Rs.2500
Junior Category

2nd

Rs.2000
Senior Category

Rs.1500
Junior Category

3rd

Rs.1000
Senior Category

Rs.1000
Junior Category



Optics

Photography Competition

Photography competition challenges the participants to visually interpret the pulse of international affairs. Moving beyond the strict framework of theory and rigid formalism, here the camera becomes a critical lens to capture power, inequality, identity, and global interconnectedness as they unfold in everyday life. Through compelling visual narratives, participants shall aim to transform complex geopolitical themes into moments that speak for themselves, even without words.

For Queries:
Debarghya: 9851138673
Samrat: 8906437630

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
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Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



RULES AND REGULATIONS:

- Participants may capture photos from any location.
- The photographs must be original submissions, and the participants must have the right to all the photographs
- Image Format: JPG, JPEG. Maximum size: Max.10 MB
- Participants may be asked to provide the raw files (e.g., CR2, NEF, ORF, PEF, RAF, ARW, etc.) and the original unedited image in JPEG format if required for authentication
- Post-processing is allowed (colour correction, removal of dust, cropping, reasonable adjustment to exposure, contrast, conversion to greyscale)
- For submission, save the photograph as FullName_Institution_Photo
- The submission shall be made through a Google Form. The participants must provide a short description (within 50-100 words) that elaborates on how the photograph aligns with the topic.

TOPIC:

- **We, the People** "Stories of the citizens who shape the Republic."
- **Witness** "Every photograph is an act of witnessing."
- **Frames of Power** "Power exists in every frame—seen and unseen."

REGISTRATION:

- The event is open for high school (+2), undergraduate, and postgraduate students from all disciplines.
- **Registration Fee: Rs. 150**

Last date for submissions: 31st August, 2026

Rs.2000

1st Prize

Rs.1000

3^d Prize

Rs.1500

2nd Prize



Articulate

Poster Making Competition

Poster Making provides a platform for participants to translate complex international issues into compelling visual representations grounded in critical insight. By blending creativity with informed understanding, this event invites artists to enrich the discourse and spread awareness on pressing themes of global politics.

For Queries:
Prachi: 8250055857
Adrija Bhaumik: 8240688037

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
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Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



TOPIC:

1. **The Cost of Connectivity:** Globalization's hidden inequalities and dependencies.
2. **Voices Beyond the West:** Emerging narratives challenging dominant global discourses.

REGISTRATION:

- The event is open for high school (+2), undergraduate, and postgraduate students from all disciplines.
- **Registration Fee: Rs. 100**

Last date for submissions: 27th August, 2026

RULES AND REGULATIONS:

- Participants may use digital design tools or hand-drawn posters
- Submissions must be original. Plagiarism or the use of AI will result in disqualification
- Posters cannot contain offensive language.
- The Posters must be submitted in PDF format. Only digital submissions are allowed.
- The file must be saved as FullName_Institution_Poster
- The submission shall be made through a Google Form. The participants must provide a short description (within 50 words) that elaborates on how the poster aligns with the topic.

Rs.1500

1st Prize

Rs.500

3rd Prize

Rs.1000

2nd Prize



PowerCut

Short Film Competition and Screening

It offers a platform for visual storytelling that bridges academic concerns with public discourse, encouraging critical awareness of international issues. Screenings will be followed by interactive discussions to facilitate dialogue, interpretation, and dissemination of socially relevant perspectives and global concerns

The Short Film Competition and Screening showcases creative cinematic expressions that engage with contemporary global themes through informed social and political reflection.

For Queries:
Debaghya: 9851138673
Trisha :8777815659

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
Q7rw44K5e1P7TL
Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



TOPICS

- **The Idea of India** *Diverse interpretations of nationhood and identity.*
- **The Choice** *Every decision is political.*
- **Fault Lines** *The deepest borders are invisible.*

REGISTRATION:

- The event is open for high school (+2), undergraduate, and postgraduate students from all disciplines.
- Both individual and team registrations (including cross-institutional teams) are allowed.
- **Registration Fee: Rs. 300**

Last Date for submissions : 1st September, 2026

RULES AND REGULATIONS

- The short film must be original. The participants must have the rights to the entire film.
- Both Mobile Phone and Camera Recordings are accepted
- The Duration of the film **must not be more than 20 minutes**
- The film can be in any language, but English subtitles are preferable. Participants must submit their work in **.mp4 or .MOV format**.
- The file must be named as: **FilmName_Institution_Shortfilm**. Submissions shall be made through a Google Form.
- The participants must avoid abusive, discriminatory, or hateful content.
- Shortlisted films shall be screened during the IRSC

*negotiable

Rs.3000

1st Prize

Rs.1000

3rd Price

Rs.2000

2nd Prize

Live
Screening

A WOMAN SPEAKING AT THE OXFORD UNION FOR THE FIRST TIME.

DRAWN BY OUR SPECIAL ARTIST, E. BULL.



Dialectica

Oxford Debate

Oxford Debate brings in the rigour of classical debating style to contemporary international questions. Framed in the traditional motion versus opposition format, our debaters shall engage in critical examination, structured argumentation, evidence-based persuasion, and strategic rebuttals on pressing global issues. It is a battle of intellect where clarity, conviction, and command over international affairs define victory.

For Queries:
Tanisha: 9862915623
Anuska: 6290674268

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
Q7rw44K5e1P7TL
Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



TOPIC :

- Motions shall be disclosed 24 hours before the debate

RULES AND REGULATIONS

- Language of debate: English, Bengali, or Hindi. Language choice must be declared beforehand
- Teams shall be able to decide their stances on their own
- The Time limit for each speaker shall be minutes, with a minute assigned for rebuttals
- The Event shall be divided into two rounds: the prelims and the finals
- Participants will be individually assessed, but strong team spirit is valued
- Using unparliamentary language, abusive words, personal attacks, or inappropriate gestures shall lead to immediate disqualification
- The Judges' decision shall be final.

REGISTRATION

- The event is open for high school (+2), undergraduate, and postgraduate students from all disciplines.
- Both individual and team registrations (of two participants) are allowed. Individuals shall be grouped into teams of two
- **Registration Fee: Individual– Rs. 150
Team– Rs. 300**

Last Date for Registration: 7th September, 2026

Rs.4000 each
Best Speaker [For & Against]

Rs.2000 each
Runners Up[For & Against]



Policy Lab

The IRSC Policy Lab is a two-day academic simulation hosted by the International Relations Scholastic Conclave at Jadavpur University, in collaboration with UNICEF's Social and Behaviour Change Communication programme.

It places participants inside the real process used by development practitioners to design communication strategies for complex social problems — from gender-based violence to public health gaps to sanitation crises.

For Queries:
Sananda: 6297937337
Aishik: 8281560407

For Registration:

[https://forms.gle/
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Qq9](https://forms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9)



What will participants do?

Teams of three to four will work through the full C4D (Communication for Development) strategy design process over two days:

Day 1 is dedicated to analysis and strategy. Teams receive a scenario brief — a real-world development communication challenge set in an Indian context — and must produce a situation analysis and communication strategy document by end of day. This involves mapping the problem across its social, individual, community, and policy dimensions; identifying the causes that communication can realistically address; defining SMART objectives; and constructing a Theory of Change.

Day 2 opens with finalising a message brief and monitoring plan, before all teams present their completed strategies to a policymaker panel — composed of UNICEF practitioners and faculty — in competitive advocacy presentations. The panel will probe, challenge, and assess.

The intellectual framework

The Lab is built on **UNICEF's nine-module SBCC curriculum**, which trains development communication practitioners globally. At its core is the Socio-Ecological Model — an analytical lens insisting that development problems cannot be solved at a single level of society. Any credible strategy must simultaneously address individual knowledge and attitudes, community and interpersonal dynamics, entrenched social norms, and structural or policy conditions.

Participants will work with frameworks including: problem tree analysis, Theory of Change, SMART communication objectives, social norms theory, communication approaches including advocacy, community dialogue, peer education, media campaigns, social mobilisation, and entertainment-education, and monitoring and evaluation design.

A pre-lab reading packet will be distributed to all registered participants in advance.

Who should participate?

The Policy Lab is designed for undergraduate and postgraduate students across disciplines — political science, sociology, economics, public health, media studies, development studies, and beyond. No prior background in communication or development studies is required.

What is required is the capacity to read evidence carefully, think causally, work collaboratively under time pressure, and argue with precision.

Students with interests in international development, public policy, social research, or civil society work will find the Lab directly relevant to how those fields actually function

Registration Fee – Rs. 350

Last date for registration (approx) – 7th September, 2026

Rs.7000

1st Prize

Rs.3000

3rd Price

Rs.5000

2nd Prize

POWER.
POLICY.
POSSIBILITY.



International
Relations
Scholastic
Conclave

At a Glance

DIPTAJYOTI:7866823834
MOHANA:7384846733
PAPER PRESENTATION

KUSHAL:7638932359
PROMIT:9051071498
QOUTUHOL - QUIZ

YASHIKA:6291699199
ADRIJA:6291540756
COMMITTEE SIMULATION

JAYASMITA:9641215740
KANGKANA:7908633186
PENQUEST

DEBARGHYA:9851138673
SAMRAT:8906437630
OPTICS

PRACHI:8250055857
ADRIJA BHAUMIK:8240688037
ARTICULATE

DEBARGHYA:9851138673
TRISHA:8777815659
POWERCUT

TANISHA:9862915623
ANUSKA:6290674268
DIALECTICA

AISHIK:8981560407
SANANDA:6297937337
POLICY LAB

FOR REGISTRATION



or

<https://for.ms.gle/Q7rw44K5e1P7TLQq9>

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AAKANSHA:9883517434
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Call For Papers

Published by the students of the Department of International Relations, Jadavpur University, Edison is the official publication of the International Relations Scholastic Conclave (IRSC). It serves as a platform where emerging scholars, researchers, and policy enthusiasts examine the ideas, conflicts, and transformations defining contemporary international politics.

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